

CI Principiante

Foundation · Roma · A0 → A1.1 · 20 lessons × 85 min

The Promise

Your first Italian, taught in Rome — the city where the language began. In twenty live lessons you go from the sound of the language to your first real conversations.

On Completion, You Can:

- › Introduce yourself, family and work in Italian
- › Order food, coffee and drinks with confidence
- › Understand slow, clear spoken Italian in daily situations
- › Handle numbers, dates, times and money
- › Write short messages and postcards in Italian
- › Read menus, signs and simple posts

The Syllabus — Week by Week

Lesson 01 · Ciao, Roma!

The Italian sound system, greetings, subject pronouns, the verb essere. Set at Fiumicino, first steps in Rome.

Lesson 02 · Chi sei?

Introducing yourself, nationalities, avere, definite articles. A dialogue at a Roman café.

Lesson 03 · La mia famiglia

Family vocabulary, possessive adjectives, plural nouns. Photos from a real Roman family.

Lesson 04 · Al bar

Ordering coffee, present tense of regular verbs (-are), c'è / ci sono. The espresso ritual.

Lesson 05 · In città

Prepositions of place, andare and venire, asking for directions. The seven hills of Rome.

Lesson 06 · A che ora?

Telling time, days of the week, months, the verb fare. A day in the life of a Roman.

Lesson 07 · A tavola

Food vocabulary, partitives, quanto costa, ordering in a trattoria. Cucina romana.

Lesson 08 · Mi piace

Piacere, opinions, comparatives, likes and dislikes. Italian film and music.

Lesson 09 · Che tempo fa?

Weather, seasons, dovere / potere / volere. Weekends in the Roman countryside.

Lesson 10 · A casa

Rooms of the house, furniture, dare and stare. Roman apartment life.

Lesson 11 · Vestiti

Clothes, colours, adjectives that agree, sapere vs conoscere. Via del Corso, the shopping street.

Lesson 12 · Al mercato

Food shopping, markets, imperative for polite requests. Campo de' Fiori.

Lesson 13 · In ufficio

Work vocabulary, jobs, telefonare, scrivere. A day in a Roman office.

Lesson 14 · In viaggio

Trains, tickets, hotels, the near future with andare a + infinitive. Termini Station.

Lesson 15 · A che punto sei?

Review, mini test, oral presentation. Half-way milestone.

Lesson 16 · Passato prossimo

Introduction to the past tense with avere. Yesterday in Rome.

Lesson 17 · Passato prossimo con essere

The past with essere, agreement of the past participle. Stories from a Sunday.

Lesson 18 · Il mio quartiere

Describing places, reflexive verbs, daily routine. Trastevere on a Saturday.

Lesson 19 · Il fine settimana

Weekend plans, imperfetto introduced, contrastive with passato. A country outing.

Lesson 20 · Arrivederci, Roma!

Full oral CEFR A1.1 assessment, farewell dialogue, next steps. Ready for CI Elementare.